

Bank card and it even offers buyers the option to take their cash back in the form of a “gold back.”

For the more rustic buyers, it's also promoting a postcard feature called Lifafa (meaning envelope in Hindi) that gives a surprise gift to every buyer who shops during its sale. It could be a digital currency, a hotel or movie booking, or even free cab rides.

Tips and tricks

One of the biggest highlights with such buying festivals is the influx of international brands or high-end smartphones. The Big Billion Days offers Apple products at a discount of 20% or above. The company also offers up to 80% off on international clothing brands such as United Colours of Benetton, Tommy Hilfiger, and Allen Solly.

And if you're still not bought on the idea of cashbacks being worth it, it's worth noting that Paytm Mall has a budget of ₹501 crore to give away in the form of cash back in just a four day period.

Amazon India is even extending certain privileges to its affiliate marketers and drop shippers who can snag in more than a certain number of sales per month. As a general rule of thumb, it's suggested that you always search for items on an incognito browser.

Many websites offer dynamic pricing based on location, browsing history and past shopping. The sites thus recognise you as an old customer and prices will change accordingly, offering discounts and rewards only to new customers. Keep that handy tip in mind.

Or you could clear your browsing history and cookies. Another trick is to use multiple e-mail IDs or phones of different family members to receive ‘first user’ or ‘new customer’ discounts.

If you're using a coupon code for any of the buying festivals, be sure to install browser extensions for Chrome and Firefox, such as BuyHatke, ShopSmart, AfterCoupon India and MakkhiChoose. These will automatically scan for discounts and coupon codes and apply them just before you check out of the e-commerce websites.

To avoid issues that may occur during peak times, remember that 60% of online purchases happen during business hours (9 AM – 5 PM). As evidenced by the peak frenzy times that occur during Black Friday sales, the average consumer level hits such intense levels that bundles items see a great surge in prices. The key is to keep away from such time periods to avoid being ripped off by higher prices. Although some retailers may have dif-